

DEMOCRACY MATTERS * DAY8

Democracy Matters

Today's Special Topic: **Bypassing instead of denial**



Civics & Basic Concepts



TODAY +★



Communication & Social Media



Action & Mobilisation



☆☆☆ are the slots per pillar. Everyone collects their own — My DM shows where you stand.

1 • Special Topic

Bypassing — the sprint

30'

2 • The round

Discussion & wind-down

The Learning Loop — Learn it. Keep it. • 3★ per pillar → DM Champion • 6★ → DM Master

SPECIAL TOPIC

Bypassing instead of denial

How to answer misinformation without just contradicting it

Warm-up

5'

Topic

10'

Exercise

5'

Take-away

5'

Why this topic? Before every vote, claims circulate that aren't true. A "that's not true" helps less than you'd think. There is a second way — and a clear line where it becomes unfair.

Sprint

30m

1 — WARM-UP

Phones out



Scan the QR, enter a name — three questions, everyone at once.

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz

Join — if the QR code acts up

Open the beamer view →

Host: starts the game and shows questions, answers, leaderboard

After each question: answer + explanation — the app does that.

Time

5m

2 — TOPIC • LIVE EXPERIMENT

An experiment with you

HEADLINE

“Tap water is unhealthy.”

1. The moderator hands out slips: **left** side of the room gets slip **A**, **right** side slip **B**.
2. Read your slip silently. **Don't show it.**
3. Show with **1–5 fingers**: how happy would you be to drink tap water instead of bottled water?

→ **Next slide: we compare the two sides.**

The paper tested with a made-up product. The tap-water example is ours.

Time

5m

2 — TOPIC • THE CHECK

What was on the slips?

HEADLINE

"Tap water is unhealthy."

Bypassing leaves the false claim standing and puts something **true** on the other side of the scale: same object, opposite direction.

A • DENIAL

"Tap water is **not** unhealthy."

In experiments, after short headlines, it worked **slightly** better than a short denial. A small edge, found repeatedly.

B • BYPASSING

"Tap water costs a fraction of bottled water and needs no plastic bottle."

No edge if people already made up their minds while reading. A detailed fact-check stays strong.

3 — EXERCISE • DISCUSSION

Fair or dodging?

"Bypassing? That's just spin."

CASE A • EXAMPLE

"The wolf kills our sheep."

CASE B • EXAMPLE

"The vote result was rigged."

CASE C • EXAMPLE

"Initiatives only make it with forged signatures."

2–3 Form groups of two or three, each group takes one case

2' in your group: bypassing ok, denial needed — or would bypassing be dodging here?

3' in the round: **one** sentence per group.

2:00

► Start timer

Time

5m

3 — EXERCISE • THE REVEAL

When bypassing doesn't fit

A • A real concern

Killed sheep are not a rumour.
Answering with something else is dodging. Acknowledge first, then talk.

B • Nothing true against it

There is no fitting counter-fact to “rigged”. This needs an explaining denial: who counts, who checks, how to file a complaint.

C • A true core

If there are individual real cases, acknowledge them first. Then correct the generalisation. Pure bypassing looks like whitewashing here.

Bypassing adds a **true** claim to a **false** one. Spin makes a legitimate concern disappear.

4 — TAKE-AWAY · BOTTOM LINE ★

“Contradicting misinformation? It’s pointless anyway.”



★ Claim your star now

Your kit for exactly that conversation:



Check first

Is it really false? If it has a true core, acknowledge that first.



A true counterweight

Same object, opposite direction, at least as strong — and it has to be true.



Say it openly

“Do you know this side too?” If that would embarrass you, it’s manipulation.



Otherwise correct

If nothing true speaks against it: explain in detail, not just “not true”.

Bottom line → Master Checklist · Communication star ★ earned

Time
5m

The round

DEMOCRACY MATTERS

Merci!

The Learning Loop — design & concept of the gamified workshop
format



Slides, quiz & star — everything to revisit

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz/content/bypassing.html

FOR THE MODERATOR

Run sheet



Run sheet on
your phone

before **Print** and cut the slips (A left, B right). No slips: read A to the left half while the right half closes their eyes — then the reverse with B.

15:00 (5') **Warm-up** — QR slide, **open the beamer view**, play the 3 questions. The app shows the explanations.

15:05 (10') **Topic** — live experiment: show the headline, slip A on the left, slip B on the right, fingers 1–5. Then the check slide: read both slips, the three findings. The room is too small for proof — if it comes out “wrong”, that is your transition.

15:15 (5') **Exercise** — one case per group: 2' in the group, then a 3' round, **one** sentence per group. Cut hard after 2'. **Only then** show the reveal.

15:20 (5') **Take-away** — go through the kit, bottom line onto the Master Checklist, award the Communication star ★. Never cut.

15:25 (5') **Buffer** — then transition into the round.

Details: [docs/runbook-bypassing.md](#) • **To revisit:** [.../content/bypassing.html](#)